

2026 EDITION

DFW GROWTH CORRIDORS

THE NEXT 15 YEARS OF
LAND WEALTH CREATION

IDENTIFYING TOMORROW'S PROSPER,
FRISCO, AND CELINA BEFORE EVERYONE ELSE



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INTRODUCTION: THE FIFTEEN-YEAR WINDOW



Every generation of North Texas land investors has had one defining opportunity. In the 1970s it was Preston Road. In the 1990s it was Plano. In the 2000s it was Frisco. In the 2010s it was Prosper and Celina. Each time, the pattern was identical: infrastructure was announced, skeptics scoffed at "paying city prices for cow pasture," a small group of disciplined buyers acquired land ahead of the pavement, and fifteen years later that land had multiplied in value five, ten, sometimes twenty times over.

The pattern is not luck. It is the most repeatable wealth-creation mechanism in American real estate: buy raw land in the path of funded infrastructure, in a metro with relentless population growth, and hold until the rooftops arrive.

Dallas–Fort Worth is now the fourth-largest metropolitan area in the United States, home to roughly 8.6 million people at the start of 2026, adding well over 200,000 new residents every single year. The region is projected to pass 9.3 million by 2030 and to become the nation's third-largest metro in the 2030s. Every one of those new residents needs a lot, a street, a school, a grocery store, and a job — and all of it gets built on land that someone owns today.

This book is a field manual for identifying tomorrow's Prosper, Frisco, and Celina before everyone else. It maps every major growth corridor radiating out of the Metroplex — the Dallas North Tollway, US-75, US-82, I-35, I-30, the Chisholm Trail Parkway, and I-20 West — city by city and county by county. It ranks the towns most likely to double in value, profiles the hidden gems still trading at agricultural prices, and lays out the acquisition, due-diligence, and exit frameworks that turn a land purchase into generational wealth.

The next fifteen years of DFW growth are already funded, mapped, and under construction. The only question is who owns the land when the growth arrives.

A note on data and disclaimers. This book synthesizes publicly available planning data, TxDOT and NTTA project documents, U.S. Census figures, regional transportation plans, and market information current as of mid-2026. Land markets move quickly; every figure herein should be independently verified before any transaction. Nothing in this book constitutes legal, tax, or investment advice. Land investment involves substantial risk, including illiquidity and the possibility of loss. Consult qualified professionals before acquiring any property.

PART I EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW



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CHAPTER 1: THE FUTURE OF DALLAS-FORT WORTH



WHY DFW OUTPERFORMS

No large American metropolitan area combines growth, affordability, and economic diversity the way Dallas-Fort Worth does. Since 2020 the Metroplex has grown approximately 11 percent — faster than any other top-five metro. In 2024 alone the region added roughly 234,000 new residents, a 2.8 percent annual growth rate that would be remarkable for a mid-sized city and is astonishing for a metro of nearly nine million.

Four structural forces drive this outperformance, and none of them is slowing down.

Corporate relocation. Texas has no state income tax, a pro-business regulatory climate, and a central location with two major airports. DFW has absorbed a steady stream of corporate headquarters and major campuses — finance, technology, logistics, healthcare, and manufacturing — each bringing thousands of high-wage jobs that convert directly into housing demand.

Domestic migration. Californians, Midwesterners, and Northeasterners continue to arrive in six figures annually, drawn by jobs and by housing that costs a fraction of coastal equivalents. Migration patterns show new arrivals increasingly leapfrogging the built-out inner suburbs and landing in Collin, Denton, Kaufman, and Rockwall counties — precisely the areas covered in this book.

Demographic momentum. DFW's population skews young. Natural increase — births over deaths — adds tens of thousands of residents per year on top of migration, guaranteeing household formation for decades.

Infrastructure commitment. Texas funds roads. The state's Unified Transportation Program, the NCTA's toll network, and regional Mobility 2050 planning represent tens of billions of dollars in funded, mapped expansion. Where those dollars land, land values follow.

THE POPULATION MATH

The arithmetic that matters to a land investor is simple. DFW stood at roughly 8.6 million in early 2026. Credible forecasts put the region at 9.1–9.3 million by 2030 and on a trajectory toward 11–12 million by 2045. Call it conservatively 2.5 million new residents over two decades. At roughly 2.7 persons per household, that is more than 900,000 new households — nearly a million new rooftops, plus the retail, schools, employment centers, and roads that serve them.

At typical suburban densities of three to four homes per gross acre, a million rooftops consume on the order of 300,000 to 400,000 acres — nearly 500 to 600 square miles of new urbanized land. That land exists today as ranches, farms, and rural tracts along the corridors in this book.

WHERE THE GROWTH IS CONCENTRATING

Growth is not evenly distributed, and that concentration is the investor's edge. Collin County alone captured roughly a third of the entire region's growth in recent years. The U.S. Census Bureau's 2026 release named Celina the fastest-growing city in America — for the second time in three years — with Princeton, Melissa, and Anna also in the national top ranks. All four sit on the two northern corridors profiled in Chapters 3 and 4.

Meanwhile a second wave is forming that most investors have not yet priced in: south along the Chisholm Trail Parkway into Johnson County, west along I-20 into Parker County, east along I-30 into Hunt County, and north along US-75 and the future Tollway extension into Grayson County. These are the frontiers where 2026 prices still resemble Celina's prices in 2010.

WHY INFRASTRUCTURE DRIVES LAND APPRECIATION

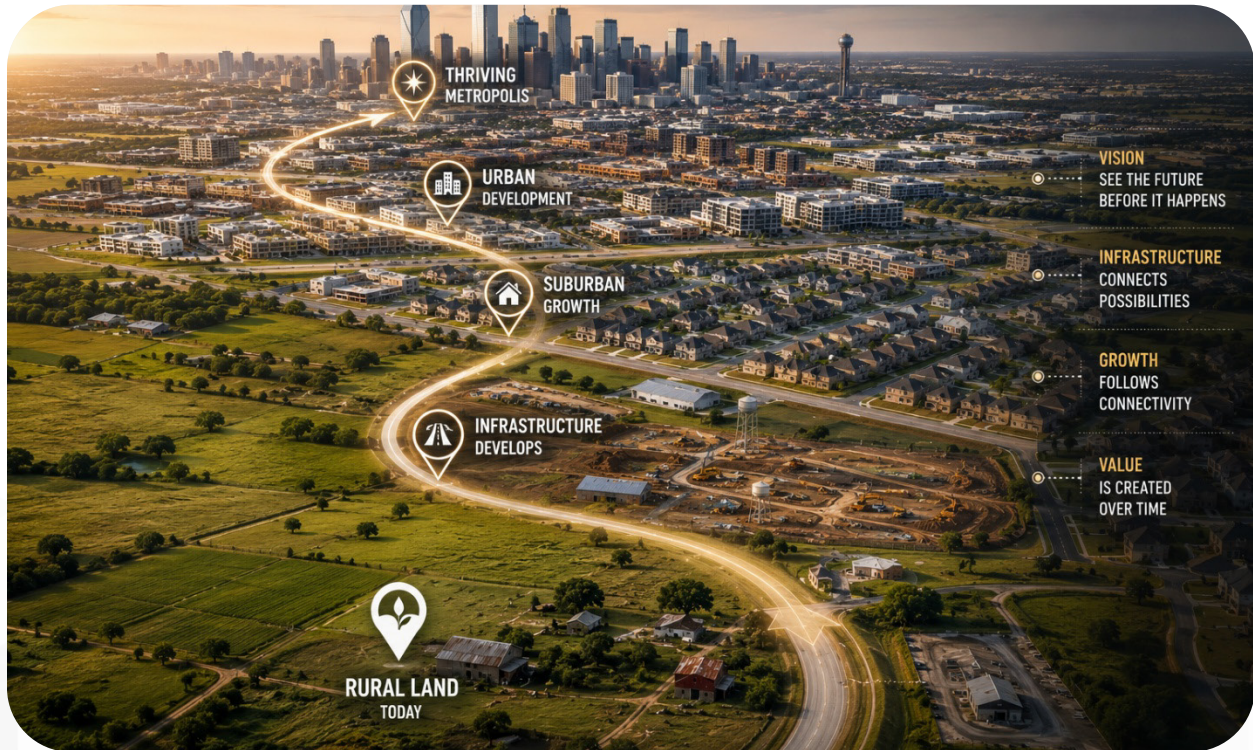
Land has no intrinsic yield. Its value is a function of what can be built on it, and what can be built is a function of access and utilities. A highway interchange converts a \$12,000-per-acre hay field into a \$250,000-per-acre commercial corner not by changing the dirt but by changing what the dirt can do.

The critical insight is that infrastructure appreciation happens in stages, and the largest percentage gains occur earliest, when uncertainty is highest:

- » **Announcement stage.** A corridor appears in a regional plan (Mobility 2050, the TxDOT UTP, an NTTA feasibility study). Prices move modestly; only specialists notice.
- » **Funding stage.** Dollars are committed and environmental clearance advances. Sophisticated capital arrives; prices typically double or triple from agricultural baselines.
- » **Construction stage.** Dirt moves. Builders and national developers begin assembling; prices reach development-lot levels.
- » **Completion stage.** The road opens. Retail pads price at multiples of what the entire acre cost a decade earlier — but the extraordinary returns have already been captured.

The entire strategy of this book reduces to one sentence: buy at the announcement-to-funding stage, in the path of committed infrastructure, in the direction the metro is already moving, and hold through construction.

CHAPTER 2: HOW GREAT CITIES EXPAND



THE HISTORICAL ARC OF DALLAS

Dallas has always grown north. From the original downtown grid, wealth and development marched up Preston Road — an old Republic-of-Texas-era trail that became the spine of Highland Park, then Preston Hollow, then far North Dallas. Each decade the "edge of town" moved roughly five to eight miles further north, and each time, the families who owned the farmland at that edge captured the difference between agricultural value and urban value.

THE PRESTON ROAD ERA

In the 1950s and 1960s, Preston Road north of LBJ Freeway ran through open prairie. Land traded for hundreds of dollars per acre. By the 1980s, the same corridor through Plano commanded tens of thousands per acre; today, commercial frontage along Preston in Plano and Frisco trades at prices exceeding \$1.5 million per acre.

The lesson was not that Preston Road was special. It was that a single continuous corridor, extended decade after decade, kept repeating the same appreciation cycle one segment further north.

THE DALLAS NORTH TOLLWAY EFFECT

The Dallas North Tollway institutionalized that cycle. Opened in stages from 1968 onward, the DNT gave the northward march a high-speed spine. Every extension triggered the same sequence: land speculation ahead of the terminus, master-planned communities at the new frontier, then commercial development filling in behind. Addison, then Plano's Legacy area, then Frisco each took their turn as the Tollway's frontier — and each became one of the most valuable submarkets in Texas.

THE FRISCO TRANSFORMATION

Frisco is the cleanest case study in modern American suburban wealth creation. In 1990, Frisco was a farm town of about 6,000 people; raw land traded at \$3,000 to \$5,000 per acre. The Tollway arrived in stages through the late 1990s and 2000s. The city aggressively recruited employers, stadiums, and retail. By 2026 Frisco exceeds 230,000 residents, and land that sold for \$5,000 an acre in 1992 has traded at \$500,000 to well over \$1 million per acre — a 100-to-200-fold gross appreciation over three decades. Investors who simply bought pasture in the Tollway's mapped path and waited outperformed nearly every asset class in America.

PROSPER AND CELINA: THE CYCLE REPEATS

Prosper (2010 population ~9,400) sat one step north of Frisco. As the Tollway and US-380 infrastructure arrived, Prosper's population passed 30,000 with a median household income of roughly \$187,000 and average home values above \$800,000. Land that traded at \$15,000–\$25,000 per acre in 2010 now commands \$200,000–\$400,000+ per acre along key corridors.

Celina, one step further north, is the current frontier. Roughly 6,000 residents in 2010; approximately 73,000 in 2026; the fastest-growing city in America, growing nearly 25 percent in a single year; projected to exceed 100,000 residents by 2035 and ultimately to build out at nearly 380,000 across its enormous 78-square-mile footprint. The Tollway's Phase 4A extension is under construction through Celina to FM 428 now, opening by the end of 2027. Celina's land prices have already moved — but its northern reaches, and everything beyond it, have not fully.



LESSONS INVESTORS CAN APPLY TODAY

The Frisco–Prosper–Celina sequence teaches five rules that govern the rest of this book.

- » **Growth follows corridors, not circles.** Metro expansion is linear along highways, not radial. Buy on the corridor, not merely near the metro.
- » **The frontier moves one town at a time.** The next boom town is almost always the next town past the current boom town, on the same road.
- » **Water and sewer are destiny.** Towns with utility capacity and a certificate of convenience and necessity (CCN) position to serve growth capture it; towns without it watch growth pass by.
- » **School districts are accelerants.** Prosper ISD and Celina ISD marketing built those towns as much as the Tollway did. A respected or fast-improving district multiplies residential demand.
- » **The discount for patience is enormous.** At every stage, buyers ten years early paid one-tenth to one-twentieth the eventual developer price. Time in the path of growth is the entire return.

Apply those rules northward past Celina, and you arrive at Gunter, Tioga, Pilot Point, Van Alstyne, Anna, and southern Grayson County. Apply them along DFW's other corridors and you arrive at the rest of this book.

PART II

THE INFRASTRUCTURE THAT CREATES WEALTH



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CHAPTER 3:

THE DALLAS NORTH TOLLWAY CORRIDOR

THE SPINE OF NORTH TEXAS WEALTH

No single piece of infrastructure has created more private land wealth than the Dallas North Tollway. Its history is a sixty-year appreciation ledger: every extension northward has converted farmland into some of the most valuable suburban real estate in America.

EXPANSION TIMELINE

- » **1968–1987:** Original tollway, downtown Dallas to I-635, then to the Plano area.
- » **1994–2007:** Extensions through Plano and into Frisco (Sam Rayburn Tollway interchange), igniting the Legacy and Frisco booms.
- » **2007–2017:** Extension to US-380, setting off the Prosper wave.
- » **2024–2027:** Phase 4A under construction now — approximately six miles from US-380 through Prosper and Celina to FM 428, three lanes each direction, scheduled to open to traffic by the end of 2027.
- » **Future Phase 4B:** The mapped extension continues north from FM 428 to the Collin–Grayson county line — a corridor of nearly 14 miles total from US-380. No firm construction date is published, but right-of-way is being preserved and Grayson County officials are actively planning for the Tollway's eventual arrival toward Gunter and ultimately the Sherman–Denison area.

THE APPRECIATION LEDGER

Along this corridor, the same acre of blackland prairie has repriced roughly as follows across the decades: \$500–\$1,000 per acre (1960s, north Dallas farmland) — \$5,000–\$15,000 (1980s–90s, Plano/Frisco fringe) — \$30,000–\$60,000 (2000s, Prosper fringe) — \$100,000–\$400,000+ (2010s–2020s, Celina and US-380 corridor). Frontage and corner tracts at major intersections have traded at \$1 million per acre and beyond. The pattern has repeated so many times that the North Texas land brokerage community treats "the path of the Tollway" as a proper noun.

WHERE THE OPPORTUNITY LIVES NOW

The investable frontier is everything from northern Celina to the Grayson County line and beyond — because Phase 4A is funded and under construction, while land beyond FM 428 still prices substantial uncertainty.

- » **Northern Celina and Weston:** Inside the path of Phase 4A/4B. Institutional buyers are active; prices are high but the infrastructure is now certain.
- » **Gunter:** The single most direct beneficiary of Phase 4B. A town of a few thousand people sitting squarely in the Tollway's mapped path in southern Grayson County, with large ranch tracts still assembled at rural pricing. Gunter is to 2026 what Celina was to 2008.
- » **Tioga, Collinsville, Dorchester:** One ring further out along the corridor's gravitational field; agricultural pricing with decade-plus horizons.
- » **Southern Grayson County generally:** The Tollway's arrival will meet the US-75 corridor's growth coming south from Sherman — a pincer movement of appreciation with Gunter, Howe, and Van Alstyne in the middle.
- » **Cities to monitor:** Celina, Weston, Gunter, Tioga, Collinsville, Pilot Point (western influence), Howe, Dorchester, and Sherman's southern ETJ.

CHAPTER 4: THE US-75 GROWTH CORRIDOR



US-75 — Central Expressway — is the oldest growth corridor in the Metroplex, and it is entering a second life. The first boom built Richardson, Plano, Allen, and McKinney. The second boom, now underway, is driven by three forces: Collin County's explosive spillover into Anna and Melissa, TxDOT's continuous widening program north to the Red River, and the semiconductor industrial revolution in Sherman–Denison. TxDOT is expanding US-75 to six lanes essentially continuously from the Collin County line northward, and the \$80 million "Last Mile" project through Anna is complete.

RICHARDSON AND ALLEN: THE ESTABLISHED ANCHORS

Richardson (pop. ~120,000) is the corridor's employment anchor — the Telecom Corridor, the University of Texas at Dallas, and a deep technology employment base. Allen (pop. ~110,000) is effectively built out, with land values at full urban pricing.

For land investors these cities matter not as buy targets but as the demand engines pushing growth northward. **SWOT summary:** strength — employment and schools; weakness — no raw land; opportunity — redevelopment plays only; threat — none material to the corridor thesis.

MCKINNEY: THE PIVOT POINT

McKinney (pop. ~230,000+, among the fastest-growing large cities in America) is the corridor's current center of gravity. The McKinney National Airport commercial expansion, a new \$70+ million terminal effort, massive employer recruitment, and the US-380/US-75 interchange rebuild all reinforce it. Raw land inside McKinney is now developer-priced (\$150,000–\$400,000+ per acre), but McKinney's growth is the engine that guarantees Melissa's and Anna's.

MELISSA: THE CURRENT WAVE

Melissa (pop. ~25,000, among the nation's fastest-growing cities) sits at US-75 and SH-121's northern terminus. Housing starts run in the thousands annually across master-planned communities; Melissa ISD is a recognized draw. Land inside the city trades at \$80,000–\$200,000 per acre; ETJ fringe tracts at \$40,000–\$80,000. **SWOT:** strength — momentum and schools; weakness — limited commercial base; opportunity — SH-121 extension northeast; threat — pricing already reflects much of the growth.

ANNA: THE VOLUME LEADER

Anna (pop. ~35,000+, consistently top-five nationally for growth) is the corridor's volume story: enormous annual housing starts, aggressive economic development, a new downtown plan, and the completed US-75 widening through town. Land: \$60,000–\$150,000 per acre in the path of development; fringe agricultural tracts \$25,000–\$50,000. **SWOT:** strength — affordability plus access; weakness — commercial tax base still catching up; opportunity — the US-75/SH-121 future interchange area; threat — heavy builder supply could moderate near-term appreciation.

VAN ALSTYNE: THE NEXT DOMINO

Van Alstyne (pop. ~6,000+ and growing fast, first town in Grayson County) is where corridor pricing steps down hard. TxDOT is widening US-75 from four to six lanes from the Collin County line to FM 902, and the congested US-75/FM 121 interchange has been added to the state's 10-year Unified Transportation Program as a Tier One project — a \$67.2 million rebuild targeted to begin construction around late 2027. Growth is exploding both inside city limits and across the ETJ. Land: \$30,000–\$70,000 per acre near the highway; \$15,000–\$30,000 on the agricultural fringe. **SWOT:** strength — first-mover position in Grayson with committed highway money; weakness — utility capacity must expand; opportunity — the Tollway/US-75 pincer; threat — annexation and MUD politics.

HOWE: THE SLEEPER

Howe (pop. ~3,700) sits between Van Alstyne and Sherman with US-75 frontage and rail. It is the least-priced town on the corridor relative to its position — fifteen minutes from the TI mega-site. Land routinely trades at \$15,000–\$35,000 per acre. **SWOT:** strength — position and price; weakness — small utility system; opportunity — industrial spillover from Sherman; threat — being skipped if utilities lag.

SHERMAN: THE SEMICONDUCTOR BOOMTOWN

Sherman (pop. ~48,000+) has transformed from a quiet county seat into one of the most important industrial cities in Texas. Texas Instruments' mega-site — an investment of up to \$40 billion across four planned fabs, with the first now open and producing — anchors it. GlobiTech (GlobalWafers) adds a \$5 billion silicon wafer plant and 1,500 jobs. Suppliers, data centers, and housing developers have followed; thousands of homes are platted or under construction. TxDOT's US-75/US-82 interchange rebuild is in planning. Land has repriced dramatically — commercial and industrial corridor tracts at \$100,000–\$500,000+ per acre; residential land \$40,000–\$120,000 — yet the surrounding ring (Howe, Bells, Dorchester, Pottsboro, Denison fringe) remains far cheaper. **SWOT:** strength — a generational industrial anchor; weakness — labor and housing supply strain; opportunity — the entire supplier ecosystem is still arriving; threat — semiconductor cycle timing on later fab phases.

DENISON: THE NORTHERN ANCHOR

Denison (pop. ~26,000) pairs historic downtown revitalization with Lake Texoma tourism, a growing medical sector, and direct US-75 access to the Red River and Oklahoma's booming Thackerville/WinStar corridor. Land remains among the corridor's most affordable at \$15,000–\$40,000 per acre near the highway. **SWOT:** strength — affordability, lake, and position; weakness — slower employment growth than Sherman; opportunity — TI spillover housing; threat — flood-prone tracts near the Red River require careful diligence.

CORRIDOR VERDICT

US-75 offers the rare combination of committed state highway money along its entire length, a \$45+ billion industrial anchor at its northern end, and a pricing gradient that still falls roughly 80 percent between McKinney and Howe. The Van Alstyne–Howe–Sherman segment is among the highest-conviction land plays in North Texas.



CHAPTER 5:

THE US-82 SUPER CORRIDOR

EAST-WEST WEALTH ALONG THE NORTHERN TIER

US-82 runs east-west across the top of North Texas — Gainesville, Whitesboro, Sherman, Bells, Whitewright junction (via SH-11/US-69 links), Bonham, Honey Grove, Paris, and on to Clarksville. Historically a farm-to-market artery, it is becoming the northern tier's economic spine, and TxDOT has commissioned the US-82 Texas Corridor Study to plan its long-term future as a "primary reliever route" for freight and regional travel across North Texas, with safety and capacity improvements advancing in both the Sherman and Paris districts (including proposed improvements from the Fannin County line to Loop 286 west of Paris).

THE DRIVERS

- » **Semiconductors:** Sherman's TI and GlobiTech investment (up to \$45 billion combined) sits directly on US-82. Every supplier, logistics operator, and employee commuting east or west uses this corridor.
- » **Bois d'Arc Lake:** The first major new reservoir built in Texas in nearly 30 years, northeast of Bonham, has created 16,600 acres of water and a wave of waterfront and near-lake land demand across Fannin County.
- » **Logistics and manufacturing:** Positioned between I-35 and I-30 with rail access, the corridor towns are courting distribution and mid-size manufacturing priced out of the inner metro.
- » **Tourism and recreation:** Lake Texoma to the west, Bois d'Arc to the east, and historic downtowns (Paris, Bonham, Honey Grove) in between.
- » **Agriculture-to-transition arbitrage:** This is some of the last \$8,000–\$15,000-per-acre land within 75 minutes of a major metro employment node.

TOWN-BY-TOWN

Sherman (covered in Chapter 4) is the corridor's western anchor and demand engine. **Bells** (pop. ~1,700), ten minutes east of the TI site at the US-82/US-69 junction, is a classic beneficiary town — commuter housing demand with land still near agricultural pricing. **Whitewright** (pop. ~1,800), south of 82 on US-69 with rail, offers some of Grayson–Fannin border country's best value. **Bonham** (pop. ~10,500), the Fannin County seat, is inflecting: its first master-planned community, Powder Creek Ranch, will deliver roughly 3,000 homes across seven phases through 2035, with Phase One groundbreaking expected in late 2026 and homes targeted at attainable \$250,000–\$450,000 price points. **Honey Grove** (pop. ~1,700) is the closest town to Bois d'Arc Lake's southern shore — the primary gateway to the new waterfront. **Paris** (pop. ~25,000) is the eastern anchor: a genuine regional hub with hospital systems, manufacturing (including major employers in food processing and metal fabrication), and a historic square, plus TxDOT improvements advancing on 82 west of town. **Clarksville** (pop. ~3,000) is deep-value frontier — decades-long horizon, single-digit-thousands per acre.

THE LAKE EFFECT

Bois d'Arc Lake deserves emphasis. New reservoirs near growing metros are once-in-a-generation events: they simultaneously create recreational demand, waterfront premiums, and — critically — municipal water supply that enables development across an entire county. Fannin County land within fifteen minutes of the lake has repriced from roughly \$4,000–\$6,000 per acre pre-construction to \$10,000–\$25,000+, with waterfront-adjacent tracts far higher, and brokers report the strongest investor interest in 100-to-500-acre tracts. The lake is the reason Fannin County appears in Chapter 12's county rankings.

CORRIDOR VERDICT

US-82 is a decade-early corridor. It lacks the funded mega-highway of US-75, but it has the metro's most powerful industrial anchor at one end, a brand-new lake in the middle, and land pricing that has barely begun to move east of Bells. Patient capital belongs here.

CHAPTER 6: THE I-35 CORRIDOR NORTH



THE WORKHORSE CORRIDOR

I-35 north of Fort Worth and Denton is the Metroplex's logistics artery to Oklahoma and the Midwest. Its growth story is different from the Tollway's — driven less by master-planned rooftops and more by industrial, rail, and supply-chain investment, with rooftops following jobs.

THE INFRASTRUCTURE PROGRAM

TxDOT is executing a phased widening of I-35 through Denton and Cooke counties: the Denton County Connections phase runs through 2027, with Cooke County phases extending construction activity to roughly 2029–2031. The endpoint is a modern six-lane interstate from Denton to the Red River.

TOWN-BY-TOWN

Denton (pop. ~160,000+) is the anchor: two universities (UNT and TWU, ~50,000 students), a diversified economy, and Denton Enterprise Airport. Land is urban-priced; the play is north of town. **Sanger** (pop. ~10,000) sits at the epicenter of the corridor's industrial story — a proposed 1,000-acre logistics center park and position between Denton's growth and the new rail investments. Land: \$25,000–\$60,000 per acre near the interstate. **Valley View** (pop. ~800) has become an improbable hotspot: H-E-B closed on more than 600 acres nearby for a master-planned supply chain campus, and BNSF's proposed logistics footprint stretches between Sanger and Valley View. **Gainesville** (pop. ~17,500), the Cooke County seat, is the northern prize: BNSF's industrial rail park began rail construction in June 2026 with service expected in 2027, and a prominent North Texas land broker's purchase of the 815-acre Pace Ranch along I-35 signals what may become the largest mixed-use development in Cooke County history. **Thackerville influence:** just across the Red River, the WinStar World Casino — among the world's largest — pushes steady traffic, employment, and hospitality demand into northern Cooke County. **Pilot Point and Cross Roads** (east of the interstate on FM 455 and US-377) are absorbing Denton–Celina spillover; Pilot Point in particular sits between two corridors (I-35 and the Tollway's gravitational field) and has attracted major master-planned community investment.

CORRIDOR VERDICT

I-35 North is a jobs-first corridor: rail parks, grocery supply chains, and logistics campuses are arriving before the rooftops, which is historically the most durable sequencing. Cooke County land between Sanger and Gainesville — much of it still \$15,000–\$40,000 per acre — is positioned for the kind of decade Johnson County is about to have.

CHAPTER 7: THE I-30 EAST CORRIDOR



THE LAKE-AND-LOGISTICS CORRIDOR

I-30 east of Dallas threads between Lake Ray Hubbard and Lake Tawakoni through the fastest-growing county-seat suburb chain on the metro's eastern flank: Rockwall, Fate, Royse City, then Greenville, Caddo Mills, Sulphur Springs, and Mount Pleasant. TxDOT's I-30 program widens the interstate to eight lanes from Bass Pro Drive to SH-205 and six lanes from SH-205 to FM 2642, with interchange rebuilds at Dalrock and Horizon — explicitly setting the stage for Fate and Royse City's next phase. The I-30 East Texas Corridor Study maps improvements all the way to Texarkana.

TOWN-BY-TOWN

Rockwall (pop. ~52,000+) is the affluent anchor — the wealthiest county in Texas by median income, effectively lake-locked and approaching build-out. Its scarcity pushes growth east. **Fate** (pop. ~27,000+) has grown tenfold since 2010 and continues to plat aggressively. **Royse City** (pop. ~20,000+, tripled since 2010) is the corridor's current frontier: the I-30/FM 2642 interchange — anchored by a Buc-ee's — has become the hottest development node in the Hunt County market, with H-E-B moving on a 92-acre site supported by a city TIRZ. Land near the interchange has repriced toward \$150,000–\$400,000 per acre for commercial; residential tracts in the ETJ trade at \$40,000–\$90,000. **Caddo Mills** (pop. ~3,500) is next in line, with a municipal airport and big-tract availability at \$20,000–\$45,000 per acre. **Greenville** (pop. ~30,000), the Hunt County seat, combines an industrial legacy (L3Harris is a major employer) with genuine affordability; Hunt County is projected to grow more than 20 percent through 2045. **Sulphur Springs** (pop. ~16,000) and **Mount Pleasant** (pop. ~16,000) extend the corridor into true long-horizon territory — dairy, poultry, and manufacturing economies with I-30 frontage at single-digit-thousands per acre.

CORRIDOR VERDICT

I-30 East is the eastern mirror of US-75: an anchor of affluence (Rockwall) pushing demand outward along a funded interstate widening, with a pricing gradient that falls 90 percent between Rockwall and Greenville. The Royse City–Caddo Mills–Greenville segment is the sweet spot.

CHAPTER 8:

THE CHISHOLM TRAIL PARKWAY — THE SOUTHERN SURPRISE

WHY THE NEXT BOOM MAY BE SOUTH

For forty years, "growth" in DFW meant "north." That consensus is the southern corridor's greatest gift to investors: it kept Johnson County cheap while the fundamentals quietly matured. The Chisholm Trail Parkway — the NTTA toll road running from downtown Fort Worth south to Cleburne — is now the spine of what regional analysts increasingly call DFW's next boom corridor, and the state has committed \$250 million to expand it.

THE EVIDENCE

- » **Fort Worth is America's fastest-growing big city**, closing in on one million residents, and its growth is pushing south and west where land remains.
- » **Burleson** (pop. ~55,000): the Tallgrass master-planned community begins Phase 1 construction in 2026; Craftmasters trade school (up to 5,000 students) and Hooper Business Park are underway near the parkway.
- » **Cleburne** (pop. ~33,000): Cleburne Station — a 75-acre mixed-use district with retail, offices, entertainment, and a minor-league ballpark at the parkway's terminus — plus new parkway-connected road projects opening now.
- » **Joshua, Godley, Keene, Rio Vista**: the small-town ring is filling in. Godley in particular — at the SH-171/FM 917 node west of the parkway — has become one of the fastest-growing small school districts in Texas as ranchland converts to subdivisions.

THE LAND MATH

Johnson County land remains among the cheapest in the inner metro ring: \$20,000–\$50,000 per acre near the parkway's southern reaches, and \$12,000–\$25,000 in the Godley–Rio Vista–Grandview outer ring — one-fifth to one-tenth of equivalent positions in Collin County. If the southern corridor performs even half as well as the northern corridors did in their equivalent decade, the appreciation multiple from these basis levels is exceptional.

CORRIDOR VERDICT

The Chisholm Trail Parkway is the single most asymmetric corridor bet in the Metroplex: a funded toll-road expansion, America's fastest-growing big city as the demand engine, institutional developers already committed — and land pricing that still reflects the old "growth goes north" consensus.



CHAPTER 9:

THE I-20 WEST EXPANSION

PARKER COUNTY: THE WESTERN FRONT

West of Fort Worth, I-20 runs through Parker County — now among the ten fastest-growing counties in Texas and increasingly identified as the early formation of DFW's next major suburban submarket. Fort Worth's westward march has made Aledo the fastest-projected-growth suburb in the Fort Worth area, while Weatherford has surged past 40,000 residents.

TOWN-BY-TOWN

Weatherford (pop. ~43,000): the county seat and anchor, with a hospital system, college, historic square, and heavy retail growth along I-20. **Aledo** (pop. ~6,000+, projected 168 percent growth 2014–2030): the school-district story of the western metro — Aledo ISD's brand drives premium rooftop demand; land inside the district commands \$60,000–\$150,000 per acre and rising. **Hudson Oaks and Willow Park**: the I-20 retail spine between Weatherford and Fort Worth, effectively infill now. **Brock**: small-town ISD premium similar to Aledo one ring further out. **Millsap and points west**: true ranch country at \$8,000–\$18,000 per acre — the long-horizon frontier.

CONSTRAINTS AND THE INVESTOR'S ANGLE

The western front's binding constraint is water — much of Parker County relies on wells and constrained groundwater. Tracts with access to municipal water CCNs or surface-water supply carry a decisive advantage and deserve a pricing premium. The corridor's opportunity set is therefore more selective than the north or south: buy school-district land (Aledo, Brock), buy I-20 frontage near Weatherford, and buy only with a clear water answer.

PART III

EMERGING

OPPORTUNITY ZONES



LANDZILLE

CHAPTER 10:

THE TOP 50 CITIES

MOST LIKELY TO DOUBLE

METHODOLOGY

Each city below is scored 1–10 on six factors — infrastructure (funded projects touching the city), economic development and job creation, affordability (upside remaining in the land basis), utilities (water/sewer capacity or credible path to it), land availability (large developable tracts), and development barriers (inverted: fewer barriers score higher). The composite drives the ranking. Scores synthesize the corridor analyses of Part II; they are judgments, not measurements, and should be re-scored annually.

TIER 1 — HIGHEST CONVICTION (RANK 1–10)

Rank	City	Corridor	Infra	Econ Dev	Afford	Composite
1	Gunter	DNT/Grayson	9	7	8	8.4
2	Van Alstyne	US-75	9	7	7	8.2
3	Anna	US-75	9	8	6	8.0
4	Royse City	I-30	9	8	6	7.9
5	Celina (north)	DNT	10	8	4	7.8
6	Sherman	US-75/82	8	10	5	7.8
7	Godley	Chisholm Trail	7	7	9	7.7
8	Howe	US-75	8	6	9	7.6
9	Pilot Point	I-35/DNT	8	7	7	7.6
10	Sanger	I-35	8	8	7	7.5

TIER 2 — STRONG CONVICTION (RANK 11–25)

Melissa, Caddo Mills, Cleburne, Joshua, Aledo, Gainesville, Valley View, Bonham, Princeton, Farmersville, Whitewright, Bells, Weston, Pottsboro, Krum. These cities combine at least one funded infrastructure catalyst with land pricing below \$60,000 per acre on the fringe. Bonham and Valley View are the two most likely to jump into Tier 1 within three years — Bonham on Powder Creek Ranch momentum and lake-driven demand, Valley View on the H-E-B and BNSF logistics investments.

TIER 3 — EMERGING (RANK 26–40)

Leonard, Blue Ridge, Trenton, Tioga, Collinsville, Dorchester, Denison, Honey Grove, Greenville, Quinlan, Nevada (TX), Josephine, Grandview, Rio Vista, Ponder. Catalysts are real but earlier-stage; horizons run 8–15 years. Pricing is largely agricultural, which is precisely the attraction: the downside is a working farm, the upside is a subdivision.

TIER 4 — DEEP FRONTIER (RANK 41–50)

Celeste, Wolfe City, Ladonia, Savoy, Ector, Tom Bean, Sadler, Whitesboro, Millsap, Kemp. Buy only with generational patience, at prices where agricultural income covers holding costs.



CHAPTER 11: THE HIDDEN GEMS

The following twelve towns share a profile: population under 10,000, land at or near agricultural pricing, and a specific, identifiable catalyst that the broader market has not yet priced. These are the towns where a disciplined buyer can still assemble 100+ acres for less than the price of a single Frisco commercial pad.



Gunter (Grayson Co.) — The Tollway's mapped Phase 4B path runs directly at it. Large ranch assemblages still exist. The highest-conviction hidden gem in North Texas.



Tioga (Grayson Co.) — Between the Tollway path and US-377, south of Lake Ray Roberts' eastern arm. Master-planned interest has already scouted the area.



Collinsville (Grayson Co.) — One ring past Tioga; deep value with the same directional thesis.



Whitewright (Grayson/Fannin line) — Rail, highway junctions, and position between Sherman's boom and Bois d'Arc Lake.



Trenton (Fannin Co.) — SH-121's northeastern extension logic eventually reaches it; farmland pricing today.



Leonard (Fannin Co.) — Explicitly identified by area brokers as a beneficiary of the Bois d'Arc wealth wave; sits between the lake and Collin County's growth.



Wolfe City and Celeste (Hunt Co.) — The SH-11/SH-34 country between Greenville and Fannin County; single-digit-thousands per acre with two corridors' gravity converging.



Ladonia and Savoy (Fannin Co.) — Ladonia touches the Bois d'Arc watershed lands; Savoy sits on US-82 between Bonham and Sherman. Both are pure land-bank territory.



Blue Ridge (Collin Co.) — The last cheap corner of America's fastest-growing county, in the path of the SH-121 extension logic and Anna-Melissa spillover.



Farmersville (Collin Co.) — US-380 corridor east, with a genuine downtown, Lake Lavon proximity, and Collin County demographics behind it.



Honorable mentions: Ector, Bells, Tom Bean, Dorchester, Josephine, and Nevada (TX) all fit the profile.

The hidden-gem playbook is uniform: buy the largest contiguous tract you can control at agricultural pricing, on or near a state highway, with utility CCN research done in advance, and let the corridor come to you.

CHAPTER 12: COUNTIES WITH THE GREATEST UPSIDE



GRAYSON COUNTY — THE #1 COUNTY-LEVEL OPPORTUNITY IN NORTH TEXAS.

Every thesis in this book converges here: the US-75 widening, the TI/GlobiTech \$45 billion industrial anchor, the Tollway's Phase 4B path, Lake Texoma recreation, and a county government actively planning for growth. Land basis remains 60–85 percent below Collin County equivalents. Steady transaction volume (over one hundred rural land sales tracked in the current cycle) shows a market that is liquid but not yet speculative.

FANNIN COUNTY — THE LAKE COUNTY.

Bois d'Arc Lake plus US-82 plus Bonham's first master-planned community. Recent price softening after the initial lake run-up is an entry opportunity, not a warning: the lake is permanent and the metro is coming.

COLLIN COUNTY — THE COMPOUNDER.

Still capturing roughly a third of all regional growth. No longer cheap anywhere, but its northern and eastern edges (Blue Ridge, Farmersville, Westminister) remain the safest growth-adjacency money in Texas.

COOKE COUNTY — THE LOGISTICS COUNTY.

BNSF rail park, H-E-B supply-chain campus, I-35 widening through 2031, WinStar traffic, and the 815-acre Pace Ranch signal. Early, cheap, and catalyzed.

HUNT COUNTY — THE EASTERN VALUE PLAY.

Projected 20 percent+ growth through 2045, the Royse City–Greenville corridor, and some of the lowest entry pricing within an hour of downtown Dallas.

JOHNSON COUNTY — THE SOUTHERN SURPRISE.

The Chisholm Trail thesis of Chapter 8. Institutional homebuilders have already moved; land pricing hasn't fully.

PARKER COUNTY — THE WESTERN SCHOOL-DISTRICT PLAY.

Top-ten state growth, Aledo ISD premium, water-constrained selectivity.

KAUFMAN COUNTY — THE VOLUME MACHINE.

Forney and Terrell's US-80/I-20 corridors have made Kaufman repeatedly the fastest-growing county in America by percentage. Late-cycle relative to this book's northern focus but still compounding.

ELLIS COUNTY — THE I-35E/US-287 SOUTH PLAY.

Waxahachie, Midlothian, and Red Oak give it three growth spines and an industrial base.

WISE COUNTY — THE NORTHWEST FRONTIER.

US-380/US-81 country behind Fort Worth's Alliance corridor; early but directionally correct.

RANKING FOR A 15-YEAR HOLD:

- 1) Grayson
- 2) Cooke
- 3) Fannin
- 4) Johnson
- 5) Hunt
- 6) Collin (edges)
- 7) Parker
- 8) Kaufman
- 9) Ellis
- 10) Wise

PART IV LAND ECONOMICS



LANDZILLE

CHAPTER 13:

LARGE TRACT ANALYSIS — 100, 200, AND 500 ACRES

WHY TRACT SIZE IS A STRATEGY, NOT A DETAIL

Price per acre falls as tract size rises — the "quantity discount" — while exit optionality changes character entirely. Understanding the economics at each size class is what separates land investors from land buyers.

THE 100-ACRE TRACT

The most liquid institutional size class. Regional builders, master-planned community developers, and 1031-exchange buyers all compete for 100-acre tracts near infrastructure. In the frontier counties (Grayson, Fannin, Cooke, Hunt), expect \$12,000–\$30,000 per acre depending on corridor proximity; in the active-wave towns (Anna, Van Alstyne, Royse City), \$35,000–\$80,000. Holding costs with agricultural exemption typically run under \$30 per acre annually in property tax plus insurance and minimal maintenance — often fully offset by grazing or hay leases. Exit: single-transaction sale to a builder or developer, typically at the moment a specific road or utility project de-risks the site.

THE 200-ACRE TRACT

The sweet spot for the strategy in this book. Large enough to command a serious master-planned buyer and to justify seller-side entitlement work; small enough to remain financeable by family offices and partnerships. Pricing runs 10–20 percent below equivalent 100-acre land. The 200-acre owner has three exits: whole-tract sale, phased sale (sell 100, hold 100 through the appreciation the first sale's development creates), or contribute-and-participate structures with developers.

THE 500-ACRE TRACT

Generational-wealth scale. At 500 acres you are no longer selling land to a developer — you are the land component of a future town. Pricing at this scale in the deep frontier can fall to \$8,000–\$15,000 per acre. The buyers at exit are national master-planned developers and institutional land banks, and a single well-located 500-acre tract in the path of a corridor can plausibly return 8–20x over fifteen years. The trade-offs: illiquidity measured in years, meaningful absolute holding costs, and concentration risk that demands the diligence regimen of Chapter 21.

THE NON-NEGOTIABLES AT EVERY SIZE

- » **Infrastructure proximity:** within 2–10 miles of a numbered highway, ideally with existing or planned frontage.
- » **Water:** know the CCN holder, well feasibility, and any surface water rights before contract.
- » **Utilities:** distance to sewer trunk lines and three-phase power materially changes exit value.
- » **Floodplain:** obtain the FEMA panels and a topographic review; a tract that is 30 percent floodplain is priced on 70 percent of its acres.
- » **Access and shape:** road frontage on two sides is worth a premium; landlocked or panhandle tracts trade at deep discounts for good reason.
- » **Agricultural exemption:** preserve it. It is the difference between negligible and punishing carry.

CHAPTER 14: DEVELOPMENT FEASIBILITY



THE RULES THAT DECIDE WHAT LAND BECOMES

ETJ (Extraterritorial Jurisdiction). Texas cities exercise limited authority over a belt beyond their limits. Recent Texas legislation (notably SB 2038) allows many landowners to petition for release from ETJs — a powerful and underappreciated tool that can free a tract from a city's subdivision rules or position it for a preferred city's eventual annexation. Know whose ETJ you are buying in and what that city's plans are.

Annexation. Involuntary annexation is now largely prohibited in Texas; annexation generally requires owner consent. This gives landowners negotiating leverage: annexation and zoning can be bargained for utility extensions and development agreements.

Utility districts (MUDs, WCIDs, FWSDs). Municipal Utility Districts finance water, sewer, and roads through district bonds repaid by future residents' taxes. Confirmed MUD viability (or a city utility agreement) is frequently the single event that doubles a tract's value. Understand consent requirements — a city whose ETJ covers the tract must typically consent to MUD creation.

Water and sewer. Identify the water CCN holder and its actual capacity; a CCN that exists on paper but lacks supply is a trap. For sewer, distance to the nearest trunk line and lift-station economics set the feasibility line. In Parker and western counties, groundwater district rules govern wells.

Roads and TxDOT access. Driveway and median-cut permits on state highways are granted by TxDOT under access management standards; a tract's commercial value can hinge on whether it can obtain a full-access driveway or shares an interchange quadrant.

Electric capacity. The grid is the new constraint. Data centers and industry are absorbing capacity; early conversations with the serving utility (Oncor, CoServ, Grayson-Collin EC, etc.) about three-phase availability and load timelines are now core diligence.

Platting and zoning. County land outside city limits and ETJs generally has no zoning — only subdivision platting rules — which is both freedom and risk. Inside ETJs, city subdivision ordinances apply. The feasibility question is always the same: what is the shortest legal path from raw acreage to sellable lots, and who controls each gate on that path?

CHAPTER 15:

THE INFRASTRUCTURE INVESTMENT TRACKER

The discipline that powers this entire strategy is systematic tracking of funded infrastructure. Below is the tracker as of mid-2026; maintain it quarterly.

Project	Agency	Est. Value	Status / Target
DNT Phase 4A (US-380 to FM 428)	NTTA	~\$450M	Under construction; open by end of 2027
DNT Phase 4B (FM 428 to Grayson line)	NTTA	TBD	Mapped; ROW preservation underway
US-75 widening, Collin line–FM 902 (Van Alstyne)	TxDOT	~\$100M+	Under construction
US-75/FM 121 interchange, Van Alstyne	TxDOT	\$67.2M	UTP Tier One; construction target late 2027
US-75 "Last Mile," Anna	TxDOT	\$80M	Complete
US-75/US-82 interchange, Sherman	TxDOT	TBD	Planning/phased
US-82 corridor improvements (Fannin line–Loop 286)	TxDOT Paris	TBD	Proposed/study
I-30 widening, Bass Pro–SH-205 (8 lanes) & SH-205–FM 2642 (6 lanes)	TxDOT	~\$300M+	Phased construction

Project	Agency	Est. Value	Status / Target
Chisholm Trail Parkway expansion	NTTA/State	\$250M	Committed
I-35 Cooke County phases 2–3	TxDOT	~\$500M+	Construction through ~2031
I-35 Denton County Connections	TxDOT	~\$300M	Construction through ~2027
BNSF industrial rail park, Gainesville	BNSF/EDC	Major	Rail service ~2027
H-E-B supply chain campus, Valley View	Private	Major	Land closed; planning
TI Sherman fabs 2–4	Private	Up to \$40B total	Fab 1 open; phased
GlobiTech wafer plant, Sherman	Private	\$5B	1,500 jobs
Bois d'Arc Lake buildout (ramps, parks, shoreline dev.)	NTMWD/private	Ongoing	Lake complete; development phase
McKinney National Airport commercial service	City	\$70M+	Terminal development

Also track continuously: county road bond programs (Collin and Denton counties run multi-hundred-million-dollar programs), bridge replacements that open large tracts, broadband grant maps (rural fiber buildouts precede exurban demand), and NTMWD/GTUA water supply projects, which quietly determine which towns can grow.

PART V

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT



LANDZILLE

CHAPTER 16:

MEGA-PROJECTS

CHANGING NORTH TEXAS

THE SHERMAN SEMICONDUCTOR CLUSTER.

Texas Instruments' up-to-\$40 billion, four-fab mega-site (first fab now producing, 3,000 jobs at buildout) plus GlobiTech's \$5 billion, 1,500-job wafer plant make Sherman one of the most consequential industrial locations in America. Semiconductor fabs are 30-to-50-year assets with deep supplier ecosystems; the full employment multiplier (typically 3–5 support jobs per direct job) implies 15,000–25,000 eventual jobs anchored to Grayson County.

DATA CENTERS.

North Texas is one of the nation's largest data-center markets, and the buildout is pushing outward in search of power and land — a new category of 100-to-500-acre land demand in exactly the counties this book covers.

LOGISTICS.

The BNSF Gainesville rail park, the proposed 1,000-acre Sanger logistics center, H-E-B's Valley View supply-chain campus, and the I-30 and I-20 distribution corridors are decentralizing warehousing into the frontier counties.

HEALTHCARE AND EDUCATION.

Hospital systems are following rooftops into McKinney, Anna, Sherman, Weatherford, and Cleburne; university expansion (UNT, Grayson College's semiconductor workforce programs) builds the labor pipeline.

AIRPORTS.

McKinney National's commercial-service push, Perot Field Fort Worth Alliance's cargo growth, and municipal airport upgrades (Caddo Mills, Cleburne, Denton) each anchor surrounding industrial land value.

The pattern to internalize: every mega-project is a demand shock delivered to a specific mile-marker on a specific corridor. The land investor's job is to hold acreage within the shock radius before the announcement — which is why Chapters 10–12 emphasize towns adjacent to announced projects, where the second-order repricing is still incomplete.



CHAPTER 17: POPULATION FORECASTS

Modeling DFW's growth conservatively (2.0–2.4 percent annually, below the recent 2.8 percent):

Geography	2026	2030	2035	2040
DFW Metro	8.7M	9.3M	10.3M	11.3M
Collin County	1.3M	1.5M	1.75M	2.0M
Denton County	1.05M	1.2M	1.4M	1.55M
Grayson County	150K	175K	220K	280K
Kaufman County	190K	240K	310K	380K
Johnson County	210K	245K	300K	360K
Hunt County	115K	130K	155K	180K
Cooke County	43K	48K	58K	70K
Fannin County	38K	43K	52K	65K
Parker County	175K	200K	240K	285K

The headline numbers matter less than the derivatives: Grayson, Fannin, and Cooke counties growing 80–90 percent over the window implies their land markets transition from agricultural to development pricing within the hold period — the exact transition that produced the Frisco and Celina returns.

CHAPTER 18: HOUSING DEMAND

DFW leads the nation in single-family permits nearly every year, with annual starts across the metro consistently in the 45,000–60,000 range. Demand-side fundamentals — job growth, migration, household formation — continue to outrun supply, while the affordability squeeze pushes buyers outward: the median new-home buyer's search radius now routinely includes Anna, Melissa, Princeton, Royse City, and Joshua, towns that were "too far" a decade ago. Celina's new-home sales jumped 61 percent year-over-year in the latest period even as median new-home prices moderated toward \$520,000 — evidence that builders are rotating toward attainable produ

ct on cheaper land, which is precisely what pulls the frontier outward.

Rental demand reinforces the thesis: build-to-rent communities are now a standard product in the outer ring, giving land sellers an additional exit buyer class. Apartment construction remains concentrated in the inner metro, but BTR and horizontal multifamily follow the highway corridors.

For the land investor the housing market reduces to one monitorable ratio: months of finished-lot supply in each submarket. When lot supply in a corridor falls below roughly 24 months, builders begin bidding for raw land aggressively — historically the moment paper appreciation becomes realizable liquidity.



PART VI

INVESTMENT

STRATEGY



LANDZILLE

CHAPTER 19:

THE LAND BANKING MODEL

BEATING INSTITUTIONAL CAPITAL TO THE FRONTIER

Institutional land banks and builder land funds now operate throughout DFW — but they carry structural constraints an individual investor does not: they need scale, near-term entitlement paths, and five-to-seven-year fund horizons. That means they systematically arrive after the announcement stage. The individual land banker's edge is time horizon and willingness to buy before certainty.

THE MODEL, DISTILLED:

- » **Follow the money, not the narrative.** Read the TxDOT UTP updates, NTTA board minutes, Mobility 2050 amendments, NTMWD capital plans, and city EDC agendas. A corridor is investable when funding advances, not when the press covers it.
- » **Buy the second town, not the first.** The town at the current construction terminus is already priced. The town one exit beyond — where the same road will logically extend — is where announcement-stage pricing lives.
- » **Buy dirt cheap enough that agriculture carries it.** If a grazing or hay lease plus the ag exemption covers taxes and insurance, time costs you almost nothing, and time is the entire trade.
- » **Control more than you buy.** Options, contracts with extended feasibility periods, and right-of-first-refusal arrangements let modest capital control large positions during the diligence window.
- » **Sell to the impatient.** The exit buyer is someone with a shorter clock: a builder who needs lots in 24 months, a developer with fund-life pressure, a 1031 buyer with a 180-day deadline. Their urgency is your margin.

SEQUENCING THE PORTFOLIO

A disciplined 15-year program acquires in waves: anchor positions in Tier 1 cities (Chapter 10) first, because their catalysts are funded; Tier 2–3 positions opportunistically as distress or estate sales surface; and one or two deep-frontier swings (Tier 4 / hidden gems) sized so that even a zero-appreciation outcome — productive farmland — is acceptable.



CHAPTER 20:

THE LEGACY INVESTMENT STRATEGY

A FIFTEEN-YEAR FRAMEWORK

Years 1–3: Accumulation. Acquire the core portfolio — ideally three to six tracts diversified across at least three corridors (for example: Grayson/US-75, Johnson/Chisholm Trail, Fannin/US-82). Complete full Chapter 21 diligence on every tract. Establish agricultural leases. Set up entity structure (typically LLCs per tract or per corridor, under a family holding entity) with counsel.

Years 4–8: Cultivation. Hold, lease, and monitor the tracker (Chapter 15) quarterly. Pursue costless value-adds: ETJ release petitions where advantageous, utility-district feasibility studies, boundary and survey clean-up, access permits. Decline early offers — the first wave of offers on a corridor is always from wholesalers arbitraging your patience.

Years 9–15: Harvest and roll. As each corridor reaches construction and completion stages, exit tracts by highest-and-best route: whole-tract sales to developers, phased sales, or participation structures. Roll proceeds via 1031 exchange into the next frontier — the corridors that will occupy this book's sequel — or transition into income assets (commercial pads, NNN ground leases) on retained corners.

Beyond year 15: Transfer. Land is among the most efficient wealth-transfer assets in the tax code: stepped-up basis at death, valuation discounts for minority LLC interests, and conservation or agricultural structures where appropriate. Plan the transfer a decade before it happens; Chapter 25 provides the framework.

The discipline that separates legacy outcomes from mediocre ones is almost embarrassingly simple: never be a forced seller. Buy at a basis agriculture can carry, borrow little or nothing, and the market's timing ceases to be your problem.

PART VII

THE INVESTMENT

TOOLKIT



CHAPTER 21:

THE DUE DILIGENCE CHECKLIST

Execute every item on every acquisition. The checklist is the strategy's immune system.

- » **Title:** Full commitment from a Texas title company; review all Schedule B exceptions; confirm mineral estate status and any severances; check for outstanding liens, life estates, and heirship gaps.
- » **Survey:** New boundary survey (Category 1A) on any tract without a recent one; confirm acreage, encroachments, fence-line discrepancies, and gaps/overlaps.
- » **Easements:** Map every recorded easement (pipeline, transmission, access, drainage); walk the property for unrecorded evidence. Pipeline corridors can sterilize development on wide swaths.
- » **Floodplain:** FEMA FIRM panels plus a topographic (LiDAR) review; in reservoir watersheds check controlled-elevation lines; price floodplain acres as amenity, not developable land.
- » **Water:** Identify the CCN holder and interview them about actual capacity and line proximity; assess well feasibility and groundwater district rules; confirm any surface water rights convey.
- » **Utilities:** Distance to sewer trunk and three-phase power; serving electric utility's capacity posture; broadband availability.
- » **Access:** Legal access confirmed by title, not assumption; TxDOT driveway permit feasibility for highway frontage; county road maintenance status.
- » **Soil and environmental:** Phase I ESA on any tract with commercial/industrial history; soils review (expansive clays affect lot economics); check for old dumps, tanks, and oil-field legacy.
- » **Taxes and exemptions:** Confirm agricultural valuation status and rollback exposure (Texas rollback now reaches back three years); model carry with and without exemption.
- » **Human factors:** Tenant and lease status, hunting leases, family heirs, adverse possession indicators, and neighbor relations — the unwritten title report.

CHAPTER 22: THE ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT SCORECARD

Score every candidate market 0–10 on each factor; multiply by the weight; sum to a 0–10 composite. Re-score annually and on any major announcement.

Factor	Weight	What to Measure
Infrastructure	20%	Funded highway/toll projects within 5 miles; stage (study/funded/construction)
Employment	15%	Major employer announcements; commute-shed job growth
Population growth	15%	5-year CAGR of city and county; school enrollment trend
Utilities	10%	Water/sewer capacity and CCN posture; electric capacity
Housing growth	10%	Permits, active subdivisions, builder presence
Affordability	10%	Land basis vs. next town in-corridor; upside remaining
Commercial investment	10%	Retail/industrial announcements; EDC activity
Transportation	10%	Corridor position; rail; airport proximity

Interpretation bands: 8.0+ acquire aggressively; 6.5–7.9 acquire selectively; 5.0–6.4 watchlist; below 5.0 pass. Applied to the current market, the scorecard produces the rankings of Chapter 10 — Gunter, Van Alstyne, Anna, Royse City, and northern Celina at the top.

CHAPTER 23:

RISK ASSESSMENT

- » **Political risk.** Annexation fights, MUD consent denials, moratoria, and anti-growth councils can stall a market for years. Mitigation: diversify across jurisdictions; prefer counties with pro-growth track records; never depend on a single city's cooperation.
- » **Environmental risk.** Floodplain remapping, endangered-species findings, and legacy contamination. Mitigation: the Chapter 21 checklist, plus conservative floodplain pricing.
- » **Financing risk.** Land loans are short-term, variable, and callable in downturns — the classic wipeout mechanism for land speculators. Mitigation: low or no leverage; if borrowing, match maturities to horizon and stress-test at doubled rates.
- » **Infrastructure delay risk.** Roads slip. Phase 4B has no construction date; UTP projects get re-prioritized. Mitigation: buy at prices that work even if the road is a decade late; weight funded construction over mapped intentions.
- » **Market cycle risk.** DFW land corrected in 1987–1991 and cooled in 2008–2011 and 2025–2026 (note the softening in Hunt, Fannin, and Cooke pricing in the current data). Mitigation: agricultural carry, no forced sales, and the humility to treat softness as accumulation opportunity rather than thesis failure.
- » **Water availability risk.** The quiet constraint on every Texas growth forecast. Mitigation: prioritize NTMWD/GTUA service areas and reservoir-adjacent counties; in groundwater country (Parker, Wise), verify before contract.
- » **Concentration risk.** A single tract, town, or corridor can disappoint for idiosyncratic reasons. Mitigation: the three-corridor minimum of Chapter 20.

CHAPTER 24:

THE TOP 25 INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITIES

Synthesizing the scorecard across all corridors — ranked by composite score, with expected 15-year gross appreciation multiple, risk level, and recommended strategy. (Multiples are scenario judgments, not promises.)

#	Opportunity	Score	15-Yr Multiple	Risk	Strategy
1	Gunter — Tollway-path ranch tracts	8.4	6–12x	Med	Bank 100–500 ac; hold through 4B
2	Van Alstyne — US-75/FM 121 ring	8.2	4–8x	Low-Med	Buy ETJ fringe pre-interchange
3	Anna — SH-121 future interchange area	8.0	3–6x	Low	Commercial-path tracts
4	Royse City — FM 2642 node ring	7.9	3–6x	Low-Med	Ring around Buc-ee's/H-E-B node
5	North Celina/Weston — FM 428 north	7.8	3–5x	Low	Pay up for certainty; hold
6	Sherman — industrial ring (Bells side)	7.8	4–8x	Med	Supplier/housing land east of town
7	Godley — SH-171 corridor	7.7	4–8x	Med	School-district growth land

#	Opportunity	Score	15-Yr Multiple	Risk	Strategy
8	Howe — US-75 frontage	7.6	4–8x	Med	Cheapest corridor frontage in Grayson
9	Pilot Point — FM 455/US-377	7.6	3–6x	Med	Between two corridors
10	Sanger–Valley View — I-35 logistics ring	7.5	4–8x	Med	Industrial-adjacent acreage
11	Gainesville — Pace Ranch/rail park ring	7.4	4–8x	Med	Follow BNSF; buy the ring
12	Cleburne — parkway terminus ring	7.3	3–6x	Med	Chisholm Station spillover
13	Bonham — Powder Creek/lake corridor	7.3	4–8x	Med-High	Lake-to-town SH-78/US-82 land
14	Melissa — SH-121 north fringe	7.2	2–4x	Low	Safest compounding
15	Aledo ISD — school-district land	7.1	3–5x	Med	Water-verified tracts only
16	Joshua/Burleson fringe	7.1	3–5x	Low-Med	Tallgrass spillover ring
17	Caddo Mills — airport/I-30 ring	7.0	3–6x	Med	Next Royse City
18	Whitewright — rail/junction tracts	6.9	3–7x	Med-High	Deep value, two catalysts

#	Opportunity	Score	15-Yr Multiple	Risk	Strategy
19	Blue Ridge — Collin fringe	6.9	3–6x	Med	Last cheap Collin dirt
20	Leonard — lake-metro corridor	6.8	3–7x	Med-High	Bois d'Arc wealth path
21	Farmersville — US-380 east	6.8	2–5x	Med	Corridor patience play
22	Tioga/Collinsville — Tollway shadow	6.7	3–8x	High	Generational bank
23	Greenville — I-30/L3 ring	6.6	2–4x	Med	Employment-anchored value
24	Denison — US-75 north	6.5	2–4x	Med	TI spillover housing land
25	Honey Grove — lake gateway	6.4	3–7x	High	Longest horizon, lowest basis

Portfolio construction guidance: a model \$2–5 million program takes anchor positions in ranks 1–8, one or two mid-list positions, and at most one rank-20+ frontier swing.

CHAPTER 25:

THE LANDZILLE LEGACY FRAMEWORK

The framework that binds this book together rests on six commitments.

Strategic land banking. Acquire only in mapped corridors with identifiable catalysts, at a basis agricultural income can carry, following the scorecard — never on narrative alone.

Infrastructure timing. Enter at announcement-to-funding stage; harvest at construction-to-completion stage. The tracker in Chapter 15 is the firm's operating heartbeat, reviewed quarterly without exception.

Capital preservation. Low leverage, three-corridor diversification, full diligence on every tract, and position sizing such that no single failure impairs the program. The first rule of a 15-year strategy is surviving all fifteen years.

Cash flow opportunities. Every acre works while it waits: grazing, hay, and hunting leases; cell-tower and billboard ground leases on highway frontage; solar options where appropriate (with careful attention to exemption and reversion terms). Interim income converts time from a cost into an asset.

Multi-generational ownership. Hold tracts in purpose-built entities under a family holding structure, with governance documents that anticipate the second generation: buy-sell provisions, distribution policies, and a written investment charter so the discipline outlives its founder.

Wealth transfer planning. Coordinate with estate counsel early: annual-exclusion and lifetime-exemption gifting of LLC interests at appraised (and often discounted) values, stepped-up basis planning, and — for legacy tracts the family intends to keep — conservation and agricultural structures that reduce transfer friction.

The Metroplex will add the population of a major American city over the next fifteen years. The roads are funded, the fabs are running, the lake is full, and the builders are moving outward on every corridor in this book. The families who own the land in the path of that growth — who bought it quietly, held it patiently, and sold it deliberately — will be the Frisco and Celina fortunes of 2040. The window is open now.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX A: MAJOR HIGHWAY REFERENCE

Key corridors and segments: Dallas North Tollway (US-380 → FM 428 → Grayson line, phased); US-75 (McKinney → Denison, widening to 6 lanes); US-82 (Gainesville → Paris, corridor study); US-380 (feasibility for freeway upgrade, eight-lane configurations studied); I-35 (Denton → Gainesville, phased widening to ~2031); I-30 (Rockwall → Greenville widening; corridor study to Texarkana); Chisholm Trail Parkway (\$250M expansion); I-20 West (Parker County growth spine); SH-121 (northeast extension logic toward Bonham); SH-289 Preston Road (parallel Tollway feeder). Obtain current maps from TxDOT (txdot.gov), NTTA (ntta.org), and NCTCOG's Mobility 2050 documents (nctcog.org).

APPENDIX B: FUTURE INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS WATCHLIST

DNT Phase 4B and any Grayson County extension study; US-75/US-82 interchange ultimate design (Sherman); US-380 freeway conversion decisions (Collin/Denton); Collin County Outer Loop segments; Loop 9 (southern Dallas County); future NTMWD reservoirs and pipelines (post-Bois d'Arc); Lake Ralph Hall (Fannin County — second new reservoir, under construction by Upper Trinity); McKinney National Airport commercial service; BNSF/short-line rail expansions; regional broadband grant buildouts.

APPENDIX C: COUNTY REGULATORY SNAPSHOT

Counties in Texas cannot zone (with narrow exceptions) but control subdivision platting, road standards, floodplain administration, and OSSF (septic) permitting. Practical implications by county are driven by staffing and policy posture: Collin and Denton run sophisticated platting processes with model subdivision rules; Grayson, Fannin, Cooke, and Hunt remain comparatively streamlined; Johnson and Parker fall between. Always confirm current subdivision regulations, ETJ maps, and development agreements directly with the county and any city whose ETJ touches the tract.

APPENDIX D: WATER DISTRICTS AND SUPPLIERS

Principal wholesale suppliers shaping the region's growth: North Texas Municipal Water District (NTMWD — Collin, Rockwall, Hunt, Kaufman service; owner of Bois d'Arc Lake); Greater Texoma Utility Authority (GTUA — Grayson region); Upper Trinity Regional Water District (Denton County; Lake Ralph Hall); Trinity River Authority; Tarrant Regional Water District (Fort Worth/Johnson/Parker). Retail service is governed by CCNs — verify any tract's CCN holder via the PUC of Texas viewer before contract.

APPENDIX E: SCHOOL DISTRICT GROWTH SIGNALS

Districts whose enrollment trajectories signal land demand: Celina ISD, Prosper ISD, Anna ISD, Melissa ISD, Van Alstyne ISD, Gunter ISD, Sherman ISD, Bonham ISD, Royse City ISD, Caddo Mills ISD, Community ISD (Nevada/Josephine), Godley ISD, Joshua ISD, Aledo ISD, Brock ISD, Sanger ISD, Pilot Point ISD. Bond elections and demographic reports (most districts publish annual demographer updates) are leading indicators of subdivision activity 24–48 months out.

APPENDIX F: AIRPORT EXPANSION PLANS

DFW International (terminal expansion program); Dallas Love Field; Perot Field/Alliance (cargo growth); McKinney National (commercial terminal push); Denton Enterprise; Sherman Municipal and North Texas Regional (Grayson — industrial aviation potential near TI); Cleburne Regional; Caddo Mills municipal (corporate/industrial). Airport-adjacent industrial land historically re-rates when commercial or cargo service is announced.

APPENDIX G: RAIL AND LOGISTICS CORRIDORS

BNSF main lines (Fort Worth–Oklahoma via Gainesville; the new Gainesville industrial rail park), Union Pacific (Dallas–Sherman–Denison), Kansas City Southern/CPKC (northeast Texas), DGNO short lines (Sherman–Denison–Greenville region). Rail-served industrial sites command persistent premiums; towns with both rail and highway (Gainesville, Sherman, Whitewright, Greenville, Caddo Mills) merit a scorecard bonus.

APPENDIX H: MAJOR EMPLOYERS REFERENCE

Sherman–Denison: Texas Instruments, GlobiTech/GlobalWafers, Tyson, Ruiz Foods, CIGNA, Texoma Medical Center. McKinney–Allen–Plano: Raytheon, Toyota, Liberty Mutual, JPMorgan Chase, Texas Health/Baylor systems. Greenville: L3Harris. Denton: UNT, TWU, Peterbilt. Fort Worth–south: Lockheed Martin, Alcon, BNSF HQ, Texas Health. Weatherford: hospital systems, energy services. Paris: Campbell's, Kimberly-Clark, Paris Regional Health.

APPENDIX I: ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT CORPORATIONS

Most towns in this book operate Type A/B EDCs funded by sales tax — their agendas are public and are among the highest-signal documents available: Sherman EDCO, Denison Development Alliance, Anna EDC, Melissa EDC, Van Alstyne EDC/CDC, Celina EDC, Gunter EDC, Bonham EDCO, Royse City EDC, Greenville Board of Development, Gainesville EDC, Cleburne EDF, Burleson 4A/4B, Weatherford EDC. Read their minutes quarterly; incentive agreements telegraph corporate arrivals months before press releases.

APPENDIX J: LAND DUE DILIGENCE QUICK FORMS

Offer-stage screen (one page): corridor and distance to catalyst; price vs. scorecard band; ag exemption status; CCN holder; FEMA panel quick-check; access; known easements. **Contract-stage checklist:** the full Chapter 21 regimen with responsible party and deadline for each item. **Closing-stage confirmations:** survey matches legal description; title policy amendments (survey deletion); exemption transfer filings; lease assignments; entity vesting per the family structure.

APPENDIX K: GLOSSARY

Ag exemption (1-d-1 valuation): Property-tax valuation based on agricultural productivity rather than market value. **CCN:** Certificate of Convenience and Necessity — the exclusive right to provide retail water/sewer in an area. **ETJ:** Extraterritorial jurisdiction — a city's limited authority beyond its limits.

MUD: Municipal Utility District — a bond-issuing district financing utilities for new development. **PID:** Public Improvement District — assessment-based financing tool. **TIRZ:** Tax Increment Reinvestment Zone — captures incremental tax value to fund improvements. **UTP:** TxDOT's 10-year Unified Transportation Program. **Mobility 2050:** NCTCOG's long-range regional transportation plan. **Rollback tax:** Recaptured taxes (plus interest) when ag-exempt land changes to non-ag use. **1031 exchange:** Tax-deferred exchange of investment real estate. **BTR:** Build-to-rent. **Entitlements:** The bundle of approvals (zoning, platting, utilities) that make land developable. **Land bank:** Acquiring and holding land ahead of development demand.

APPENDIX L: SOURCES AND FURTHER READING

Primary public sources synthesized in this book: U.S. Census Bureau population estimates and releases (2024–2026); Texas Demographic Center projections; TxDOT Unified Transportation Program, project pages, and the US-82 and I-30 corridor studies; NTTA project reports for DNT Phase 4A/4B and Chisholm Trail Parkway; NCTCOG Mobility 2050; Texas Real Estate Research Center (Texas A&M) rural land market reports; North Texas Municipal Water District (Bois d'Arc Lake) and Upper Trinity (Lake Ralph Hall) documents; Governor's office announcements on Texas Instruments and GlobiTech; city and EDC publications for Sherman, Anna, Van Alstyne, Celina, Bonham, Royse City, Burleson, and Cleburne; and reporting by Dallas Innovates, Community Impact, Fort Worth Report, HousingWire, Axios Dallas, and regional outlets. All figures should be re-verified against current primary sources before transacting.

Prepared for Landzille LLC. This work synthesizes publicly available planning data, regional transportation plans, and market information to identify locations positioned to benefit from long-term infrastructure investment and regional growth. It is provided for informational purposes only and does not constitute investment, legal, or tax advice. © 2026 Landzille LLC. All rights reserved.



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